

0 TO 100 • 0 TO 100 SERIES

The Complete Beginner's Guide

Part of the 0 to 100 Series

0 to 100: Content Creation — The Complete Beginner's Guide

You're holding a roadmap, not a motivational speech. This guide takes you from zero — no audience, no equipment, no budget — to a working content operation that earns money. Everything here uses free tools. Every stage ends with an action step. Do the steps in order and don't skip ahead: the people who fail at content creation almost always fail because they tried to do Stage 8 before Stage 3.

How this guide is structured: Two phases. Phase 1 (0→50) builds your foundation — platform, niche, engine, cadence, and feedback loop. Phase 2 (50→100) scales it — repurposing, community, monetization, email, and systems. Budget required: \$0. Time required: 30–60 minutes a day, most days, for roughly six months.

One rule before you start: **you are not allowed to buy anything until you've earned your first \$100 from content.** Not a microphone, not a course, not a Canva Pro subscription. Constraints force skill.

Phase 1: Foundation (0→50)

Stage 1: Pick Your Platform and Format

The biggest beginner trap is trying to be everywhere. You will pick **one platform** and **one format** and stay there for at least 90 days. Repurposing comes later (Stage 6) — earning the right to repurpose comes first.

Your choice depends on two things: what you can produce consistently, and where your future audience already spends time.

Platform	Best format	Best if you...	Time per post	Monetization speed
TikTok / Reels / Shorts	Short vertical video (15–60s)	Can talk to a camera or do voiceovers	30–60 min	Fast reach, slower direct income
YouTube (long-form)	8–15 min video	Can explain things in depth	3–6 hrs	Slow start, best long-term

X (Twitter)	Threads + short posts	Write well, think in hooks	15–45 min	Fast if niche is business/tech
LinkedIn	Text posts + carousels	Have professional experience	20–40 min	Best for B2B/services
Instagram	Carousels + Reels	Visual niche (fitness, food, design)	30–60 min	Medium
Blog/Newsletter	Written articles	Hate cameras, love writing	2–4 hrs	Slow, but you own the audience

Decision shortcut: If you're unsure, pick short vertical video (TikTok + auto-crosspost to Reels/Shorts later). It has the fastest feedback loop — you'll learn in 30 days what would take a blogger a year to learn.

Free tools for this stage:

- **CapCut** (desktop or mobile) — video editing, auto-captions, templates. The industry default for short-form.
- **Canva** (free tier) — carousels, thumbnails, cover images.
- **OBS Studio** — free screen recording if your content involves a computer screen (tutorials, gaming, software).
- **Your phone camera** — every phone made after 2019 shoots better video than you need. Film near a window for free lighting.
- **Audacity** — free audio cleanup if your mic sounds rough.

Common mistakes:

1. Buying gear first. Your phone and free daylight beat a \$300 setup used inconsistently.
2. Choosing a platform because you *consume* it, not because you can *produce* for it. You can love watching YouTube and still be a terrible fit for making 10-minute videos.
3. Splitting effort across three platforms "to see what works." You'll learn nothing on any of them.

Realistic timeline: 1–3 days to decide. Not weeks. A mediocre platform choice executed hard beats a perfect choice you're still researching.

➡ **Action step:** Write one sentence: "For the next 90 days I will post [format] on [platform]." Put it somewhere you'll see daily. Install the tools for that format today.

Stage 2: Niche + Positioning

"Niche" doesn't mean picking a topic — it means picking a **specific person with a specific problem** and becoming the account they think of first.

Numbered steps:

1. **List 3 topics** you can talk about for 100 posts without dying of boredom. Knowledge helps but isn't required — "learning in public" (documenting your journey as a beginner) is one of the strongest positioning angles available, and it requires zero expertise.
2. **Run each through the three filters:** (a) Do people spend money in this space? (b) Is there active demand — are creators in this niche getting views right now? (c) Can you produce here for six months? Kill any topic that fails a filter.
3. **Narrow one level down.** "Fitness" is dead. "Fitness for new dads with 20 minutes a day" is a niche. "Cooking" is dead. "\$15/week student meal prep" is a niche. The formula: **[topic] for [specific person] who [specific constraint or goal]**.
4. **Write your positioning line:** "I help [who] do [what] without [pain point]." This goes in your bio, and more importantly, it becomes the filter for every piece of content: if a post idea doesn't serve that person, you don't make it.
5. **Study 5 accounts** already winning in your niche. For each, save their 5 most popular posts (use TikTok's search sorted by likes, YouTube's "Popular" tab, or just scroll their profile). You now have a 25-post swipe file of proven ideas. You will not copy them — you will make your own version with your angle.
6. **Set up your profile:** clear face or logo photo (Canva free templates), positioning line in bio, no link yet (you have nothing to link to — that's fine).

Common mistakes:

1. Picking a niche purely for money that you have zero interest in. You'll quit at post 20.
2. Going so narrow there's no audience ("keto for left-handed accountants"). If the top account in your proposed niche has under 10k followers, widen slightly.
3. Agonizing for weeks. Your niche will refine itself through data in Stage 5 anyway. Pick, post, adjust.

Realistic timeline: 3–5 days including competitor research.

➡ **Action step:** Fill in the blank and put it in your bio today: "I help _____ do _____ without _____."

Stage 3: The Content Engine — Hooks, Formats, Batching

Consistency doesn't come from motivation. It comes from a system that makes creating content mechanical. That system has three parts.

Part 1: Hooks. The first 1–3 seconds (video) or first line (text) decide whether anyone sees the rest. Master these six hook patterns — they cover 90% of what works:

Hook type	Template	Example
Negative/warning	"Stop doing X"	"Stop editing your videos like this"
Curiosity gap	"The X nobody talks about"	"The Canva feature nobody uses"
Specific result	"How I got X in Y days"	"How I hit 1,000 followers in 30 days"
Mistake	"I wasted X so you don't have to"	"I posted 50 videos wrong. Here's the fix"
Contrarian	"X is a lie / you don't need X"	"You don't need a camera to make videos"
List	"N things/tools/mistakes for X"	"5 free tools that replace a \$500 editor"

Keep a "hook bank": every time you stop scrolling for someone else's post, write down *why* in a note. After a month you'll have 50+ hooks tuned to your niche.

Part 2: Formats. Pick 3 repeatable content formats and rotate them. Examples: (a) quick tip in 30 seconds, (b) "watch me do X" process video, (c) reaction/breakdown of something in your niche. Repeatable formats kill the "what do I post today?" problem — you're never inventing from scratch, just filling in a template.

Part 3: Batching. Creating one post at a time is the least efficient way to work. Instead:

- Idea day (30 min/week):** Generate 10–15 ideas. Sources: your swipe file, comments on competitor posts (every question in a comment section is a content idea), AnswerThePublic (free searches/day), and ChatGPT free tier ("give me 20 short-video ideas for [niche] using the [hook type] format").
- Script day (60 min/week):** Write 5–7 short scripts or outlines. For short video: hook (1 line) → payoff (3–5 lines) → call to action (1 line). Under 100 words each.
- Record day (60–90 min/week):** Film everything in one session. Same setup, same lighting, batch of 5–7.
- Edit day (60–90 min/week):** CapCut: auto-captions on everything, cut dead air, trending audio at low volume. Done is better than cinematic.

That's 4–5 hours a week producing 5–7 posts. Keep everything organized in **Notion (free)** or **Google Sheets**: columns for Idea → Hook → Status → Post date → Views. This spreadsheet becomes your most valuable asset in Stage 5.

Common mistakes:

- Spending 3 hours editing one video. Beginner content gets better through reps, not polish. Post 60 at 80% quality beats post 6 at 99%.
- Writing hooks last. Write the hook *first* — if the hook is weak, the post is dead no matter what follows.
- No CTA. Every post ends with one small ask: "follow for more [niche]" is fine.

Realistic timeline: 1 week to set up the system and produce your first batch.

➡ **Action step:** Build your content tracker (Notion or Sheets), write 10 hooks using the table above, and script your first 5 posts this week.

Stage 4: Publishing Cadence and Your First 100 Posts

Here's the truth nobody sells you: **your first 100 posts are practice.** Some will flop. A few will surprise you. All of them are tuition, and unlike a course, this tuition is free and pays you back in data.

Numbered steps:

1. **Set your cadence and treat it as non-negotiable:** short video = 1/day (or minimum 5/week); text posts = 1–2/day; long YouTube = 1–2/week; blog = 1–2/week. Sustainable beats impressive. A pace you keep for 6 months beats a heroic pace you abandon in 3 weeks.
2. **Post at consistent times.** Don't overthink "optimal hours" — consistency matters more. Pick a slot when your target audience is likely scrolling (7–9am, 12–1pm, or 7–10pm local) and hold it.
3. **Front-load a buffer.** Before you publish post #1, have 5–7 finished posts banked. The buffer is what saves your streak when life happens.
4. **Use free schedulers** once you're steady: **Meta Business Suite** (Instagram/Facebook, free), **TikTok's native scheduler** (desktop, free), **Buffer free plan** (3 channels, 10 scheduled posts), **YouTube's built-in scheduling.**
5. **Engage for 15 minutes after posting.** Reply to every comment, leave genuine comments on 5–10 accounts in your niche. Early replies boost your post; niche comments put your name in front of exactly the right audience for free.
6. **Track every post** in your Stage 3 spreadsheet: views at 24h and 7 days, likes, comments, follows gained. Ten seconds per post, and it powers everything in Stage 5.
7. **Do not delete flops.** Old posts sometimes resurface on algorithmic platforms weeks later, and your flop data is as instructive as your wins.

The milestone mindset: at ~post 20 you'll want to quit (normal — push through), by ~post 50 you'll be noticeably faster and one or two posts will have outperformed the rest (that's signal), by post 100 you'll have real data, real skill, and almost certainly your first few hundred followers.

Common mistakes:

1. Judging the account after 10 posts. The algorithm barely knows you exist yet. 100 posts is the minimum sample size.
2. Chasing trends outside your niche for views. 50k views from people who will never care about your topic grows nothing.
3. Breaking the streak because one post flopped. Flops are data points, not verdicts.

4. Constantly rebranding mid-run. No niche changes, no profile overhauls until post 100 (small refinements from data are fine).

Realistic timeline: at 5–7 posts/week, 100 posts takes **14–20 weeks**. This stage overlaps with Stage 5 — you iterate while you publish.

➡ **Action step:** Bank 5 finished posts, then publish post #1 today. Write "1/100" somewhere visible and count up.

Stage 5: Analytics and Iteration

Posting without reviewing data is throwing darts blindfolded. From post ~20 onward, you run a simple weekly review that turns your account into a self-improving machine.

Numbered steps — the 30-minute weekly review:

1. **Open your platform analytics** (all free): TikTok Analytics, Instagram Insights, YouTube Studio, X Analytics. Enable the creator/pro account toggle if you haven't — it's free.
2. **Find your top 20% of posts** by views for the week. For each, note: hook type, format, topic, length. Add these to your tracker.
3. **Diagnose with the funnel:** each metric points to a different fix.

Symptom	Metric	Fix
Nobody sees it	Low reach/impressions	Hook problem or topic problem — test proven hook formats
They see it, don't watch	Low retention / high drop-off at 3s	First 3 seconds too slow — cut the intro, start mid-action
They watch, don't act	Views fine, low likes/comments	No emotion or no CTA — add a question or stronger ending
They engage, don't follow	Engagement fine, no follower growth	Profile problem — unclear bio, inconsistent niche

1. **Check retention graphs** (TikTok and YouTube show these free). The exact second people leave tells you exactly what to cut next time.
2. **Apply the 80/20 rule:** next week, make 80% of your content variations of what already worked (same format, new topic; same topic, new hook) and 20% new experiments.
3. **Double down on breakouts.** If one post massively outperforms, make a part 2 within 48 hours, answer its comments with new posts, and turn it into a series. One breakout post, properly mined, can fuel a month of content.

4. **Monthly zoom-out:** review follower growth, your 5 best posts of the month, and whether your niche needs a small steer (data > opinions).

Common mistakes:

1. Checking stats hourly. Emotionally exhausting and statistically meaningless. Once a week, scheduled.
2. Optimizing for likes instead of retention and follows. Retention feeds the algorithm; follows build the asset.
3. Ignoring comments as data. "Wait, how did you do X?" in your comments is your next post, pre-validated.
4. Changing five variables at once. Change one thing per experiment or you learn nothing.

Realistic timeline: ongoing from week 3. By the end of Phase 1 (months 3–5) you should know your two best formats, your three best topics, and your best hook styles — and have somewhere between 500 and a few thousand followers. That's all Phase 2 needs.

➡ **Action step:** Put a 30-minute "content review" block in your calendar for the same time every week. Do the first one now on whatever you've posted so far.

Phase 2: Scale (50→100)

You now have a working engine: one platform, a defined audience, proven formats, and a weekly feedback loop. Phase 2 multiplies output, deepens the relationship with your audience, and turns attention into income.

Stage 6: Growth Systems and Repurposing Across Platforms

You earned the right to expand. The rule: **create once, publish everywhere — without multiplying your workload.** Your home platform stays primary; everything else is derivative.

Numbered steps:

1. **Map your repurposing chain.** Every asset becomes 4–6 pieces:
 - Short video → post natively to TikTok, Reels, *and* YouTube Shorts (upload separately to each — native uploads outperform watermarked crossposts; use a watermark remover-free export straight from CapCut).
 - Video script → X/Threads text post or LinkedIn post (you already wrote it — reformat, don't rewrite).
 - Top 3 tips from the week → Canva carousel for Instagram/LinkedIn.
 - Long YouTube video → 3–5 shorts cut from its best moments (CapCut, or **OBS** recordings chopped into clips if you do screen content).

1. **Sequence, don't parallelize.** Add ONE secondary platform per month. Month 1 of Phase 2: add the easiest crosspost (Shorts/Reels if you're on TikTok). Month 2: add a text platform. Never let secondary platforms consume more than 20% of your time.
2. **Add 30 minutes to edit day** for repurposing. That's the whole cost — no new record days.
3. **Batch-schedule secondary platforms** with Meta Business Suite and Buffer's free plan so they run on autopilot.
4. **Adapt the packaging, not the substance.** Same idea everywhere; different hook style per platform (LinkedIn wants a professional angle, X wants a punchy first line, Reels wants visual movement in second one).
5. **Add collaboration as a growth lever:** duets/stitches (TikTok), replies to big accounts in your niche (X/LinkedIn — thoughtful replies on large posts are free exposure), and small creator collabs (DM accounts your size for a joint post; most say yes).

Common mistakes:

1. Auto-crossposting with watermarks. Instagram and YouTube demonstrably suppress TikTok-watermarked video.
2. Treating every platform as primary. You'll burn out in six weeks. One home base, satellites everywhere else.
3. Expanding before the home platform works. If your main account is still flatlining, repurposing multiplies zero.

Realistic timeline: 2–3 months to layer in two secondary platforms comfortably.

➡ **Action step:** Pick your first secondary platform and repost your 10 best-performing pieces there this week (re-exported clean, native uploads).

Stage 7: Community and Engagement Loops

Followers are a number. A community is an asset. The difference is whether people *interact* — and interaction is engineered, not hoped for.

Numbered steps:

1. **Reply to every comment for your first year.** Non-negotiable. Replies double the comment count (yours + theirs), signal the algorithm, and turn casual viewers into regulars. Reply with questions when possible — threads beget threads.
2. **Build engagement loops into the content itself:** end posts with a specific, low-effort question ("Which tool do you use — A or B?" outperforms "thoughts?"); run polls (X, LinkedIn, IG Stories — all free); make "you asked, I answered" content from comments so commenters feel ownership.

3. **Create recurring rituals.** A named weekly series ("Free Tool Friday," "Monday Q&A") gives people a reason to come back on a schedule. Pick one and run it for 8 weeks minimum.
4. **Use DMs deliberately.** When someone comments something thoughtful, thank them in DMs (no pitch — just human). Instagram/TikTok DM auto-replies to keywords can come later; genuine DMs come first. These people become your first customers in Stage 8, and they'll tell you exactly what to sell.
5. **Spend 15 minutes a day being a community member, not just a broadcaster:** comment on niche accounts, answer questions in your niche's spaces (relevant subreddits, Discord servers, Facebook groups — all free), and be genuinely useful with no link-dropping.
6. **Start a free gathering point once you pass ~1,000 engaged followers: a Discord server** (free) or **broadcast channel** (Instagram/WhatsApp, free). Keep it simple: one welcome channel, one chat, one channel where you share things first. Owning a direct line to your core 50–200 people matters more than the follower count.

Common mistakes:

1. Broadcasting without listening. Accounts that never reply plateau — the algorithm and the humans both notice.
2. Buying followers or joining engagement pods. Dead weight that poisons your analytics and your reach.
3. Starting a Discord at 200 followers. An empty server feels worse than no server. Wait for critical mass.
4. Ignoring your superfans. The 20 people who comment on everything are your street team, beta testers, and first buyers. Learn their names.

Realistic timeline: community compounds from month 4 onward; a real core forms around months 6–8.

➡ **Action step:** For the next 7 days, reply to 100% of your comments and leave 10 genuine comments a day on niche accounts. Track what it does to your reach.

Stage 8: Monetization — Digital Products, Affiliate, Sponsorships, UGC

You don't need 100k followers to earn. You need 1,000 people who trust you and one clear offer. Here are the four beginner-viable income streams, in the order you should attempt them.

Stream	Followers needed	Startup cost	Effort	Income potential (early)
Affiliate marketing	~500+	\$0	Low	\$50–500/mo

Digital products	~1,000 engaged	\$0	Medium (front-loaded)	\$100–2,000/mo
UGC (user-generated content)	0 — brands buy the content, not your audience	\$0	Medium	\$100–1,500/mo
Sponsorships	~5,000–10,000 niche followers	\$0	Low	\$50–500/post

Numbered steps:

- 1. Start with affiliate (month 4+).** Recommend only tools you genuinely use — the free tools in this guide all have paid tiers with affiliate/referral programs, and Amazon Associates covers physical products. Put the link in your bio via **Beacons or Linktree (free)** and mention it naturally when the tool appears in your content. Always disclose (#ad / "affiliate link") — it's the law and it builds trust. Deep-dive: the *0 to 100: Affiliate Marketing* guide in this series covers this stream end to end.
- 2. Build your first digital product (months 5–6).** The formula: find the question your audience asks most (your comments and DMs already contain it) → package the answer as a PDF guide, Notion template, preset pack, or mini-course. Build it with **Canva (free)** or **Google Docs exported to PDF**. Sell via **Gumroad or Payhip** (free to start; they take a cut per sale only). Price at \$5–19 — low enough for an impulse buy from a new audience. One sale a day at \$9 is \$270/month.
- 3. Validate before you build.** Post: "I'm putting together a guide on X — who'd want it?" If fewer than 10 people respond across your platforms, pick a different topic. Never spend three weeks building something nobody asked for.
- 4. Launch imperfectly.** Announce it in content 3–5 times over launch week (different hooks, same product), pin it, add it to your bio link. Then keep mentioning it once or twice a week forever — most sales come from the long tail, not launch day.
- 5. Add UGC if you want income without an audience.** Brands pay creators to make ads they run on their *own* channels — your follower count is irrelevant; your content skill (which you now have from 100+ posts) is the product. Build a 3-example portfolio using products you own, then apply on free UGC job boards, Twitter search ("UGC creators wanted"), and by pitching small brands directly. Typical rates: \$50–150 per video as a beginner.
- 6. Take sponsorships selectively (5k+ followers).** Inbound offers will start via DM/email. Rule of thumb: floor of \$10–25 per 1,000 followers per post in most niches, higher for niche B2B. Only promote what fits your positioning — one bad sponsor costs more trust than the fee is worth.
- 7. Reinvest nothing until \$100.** Then, if you want, upgrade one tool. Constraint discipline continues.

Common mistakes:

1. Monetizing at 50 followers. Pitching to nobody wastes the pitch and looks desperate. Build trust first; the order above exists for a reason.
2. Building a \$99 flagship course as your first product. Start at \$9. Learn to sell before you learn to sell big.
3. Promoting products you've never used. Your audience can tell, and the make-money-online space punishes fakes fast.
4. Relying on one income stream. By month 8 you want at least two of the four running.

Realistic timeline: first affiliate dollars months 4–6; first product sales months 5–7; meaningful income (\$300–1,000/mo) months 8–12 with consistent execution.

➡ **Action step:** Sign up for one affiliate program for a tool you already use daily, add the link to a free Beacons/Linktree page, and mention it in one post this week.

Stage 9: Building an Email List

Every platform can throttle your reach, suspend your account, or die (ask anyone who built on Vine). Your email list is the only audience you *own*. Every serious creator's biggest regret is starting it late — so you're starting now.

Numbered steps:

1. **Pick a free email platform: MailerLite** (free to 1,000 subscribers, includes automation), **Kit** — **formerly ConvertKit** (free to 10,000 subscribers, creator-focused), or **Beehiiv** (free to 2,500, great if your emails *are* the content). Any of them works; don't spend more than 20 minutes choosing.
2. **Create a lead magnet** — a free, genuinely useful asset exchanged for an email address. Fastest wins: a checklist or cheat sheet PDF (Canva, one page), a Notion template, a swipe file, or a short email mini-course (5 emails, auto-delivered). Rule: it should solve one specific problem in under 10 minutes. Your best-performing content topic tells you exactly what it should be.
3. **Set up the pipeline:** landing page (built into all three platforms above, free) → link in bio via your Beacons/Linktree → automated welcome email that delivers the magnet.
4. **Write a 3-email welcome sequence** (all platforms automate this free): Email 1 — deliver the freebie + your one-line story. Email 2 (day 2) — your best advice, no pitch. Email 3 (day 4) — soft mention of your paid product. This runs on autopilot forever.
5. **Promote the lead magnet in content** once or twice a week: make a post about the problem, and the CTA is "free checklist in my bio." Direct, honest, effective.
6. **Email your list weekly.** One useful email — a tip, a lesson from this week's content, a resource. Consistency matters more than brilliance. Every fourth email or so can sell.
7. **Watch the metric that matters:** with a warm list, expect 30–50% open rates and roughly \$1 per subscriber per month once you have products to sell. A 500-person list often out-earns a

20,000-follower account.

Common mistakes:

1. "I'll start the list when I'm bigger." Every month you wait is subscribers lost forever. Start at any size.
2. A lazy lead magnet ("subscribe for updates!"). Nobody wants updates. They want a specific problem solved.
3. Collecting emails and never sending. A cold list is a dead list — weekly cadence from day one.
4. Buying email lists or adding people without consent. Kills deliverability and is illegal in most jurisdictions.

Realistic timeline: setup weekend (4–6 hours total). Growth of 50–200 subscribers/month once you promote consistently. Start this in month 4–5, alongside monetization.

➡ **Action step:** Create a free MailerLite/Kit account and build your one-page lead magnet in Canva this weekend. Link goes in your bio by Monday.

Stage 10: Systemizing With AI Tools and Templates

You now run: one primary platform, 2–3 secondaries, a community, an email list, and at least one income stream. Done manually, that's 20+ hours a week. Systemized, it's under 10. The goal of Stage 10 is to make the machine run on templates and AI assistance so your time goes into the two things only you can do: ideas and being on camera (or on the page).

Numbered steps:

1. **Template everything you do more than twice.** Script templates for each of your 3 formats (fill-in-the-blank hook/body/CTA). CapCut templates for your editing style (save caption presets, transitions, end cards). Canva Brand Kit basics work on free tier — save your 2 fonts and 3 colors and duplicate past designs instead of starting fresh. Email templates for your weekly send and for sponsor replies.
2. **Use AI (free tiers of ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini) at the right points in the pipeline:**
 - *Ideation:* "Here are my 10 best-performing hooks: [paste]. Generate 20 new hooks in the same style for [topic]."
 - *Repurposing:* "Turn this 60-second video script into a LinkedIn post / an X thread / a newsletter section: [paste]." (This alone automates half of Stage 6.)
 - *Comments-to-content:* paste a week of comments and ask for the top 5 recurring questions → next week's topics.
 - *Editing assistance:* CapCut's built-in auto-captions, auto-cut, and script-to-clip features are AI you're already using.

1. **Never let AI replace your voice.** AI drafts, you rewrite. Audiences unsubscribe from generic. The rule: AI produces the first 70%, your judgment and stories produce the 30% that makes it yours.
2. **Build a one-page operating system** in Notion (free): your weekly schedule (idea day, script day, record day, edit day, review day), your content tracker, your template library, and your metrics dashboard. Everything in one place = nothing lives in your head.
3. **Run a monthly CEO hour:** review income by stream, growth by platform, what to cut, what to double. You're no longer just a creator — you're running a small media business, and businesses review their numbers.
4. **When revenue justifies it** (and only then), consider paid upgrades in this order: scheduling tool → CapCut Pro/Canva Pro → outsourcing editing (Fiverr, or a fan from your community). Each purchase must buy back hours you'll reinvest in content.

Common mistakes:

1. Automating before standardizing. Systemize a *proven* process, not a flailing one — that's why this is Stage 10, not Stage 2.
2. Publishing raw AI output. It reads generic, performs badly, and erodes the trust you spent nine stages building.
3. Tool hopping. Every new app costs a week of momentum. Your stack is boring on purpose: CapCut, Canva, Notion/Sheets, one scheduler, one email platform, one AI chat.
4. Systemizing yourself out of the fun. Keep manual the parts you love — that energy is visible in the content.

Realistic timeline: 2–3 weeks to build templates and the Notion OS; time savings compound immediately after. By month 9–12 you should produce more than you did in month 3 at half the weekly hours. (For a much deeper dive on AI-powered workflows and income, see *0 to 100: Earning Money with AI* in this series.)

➡ **Action step:** This week, turn your single best-performing post into three templates: its script structure, its edit style, and its repurposed text version. That's the seed of your template library.

Where You Are Now — and What's Next

If you've worked through all ten stages, look at what exists that didn't before: a focused account on a platform you chose deliberately, a niche and positioning line that filter every decision, a content engine producing 5–7 posts a week in a few batched hours, 100+ published posts and the skill that only reps can buy, a weekly analytics loop steering the ship, content flowing across multiple platforms from a single effort, a community that talks back, at least one income stream — likely two — an email list you own outright, and a template-and-AI system that runs it all in under 10 hours a week. That's not "trying content creation." That's a small media business, built for \$0.

The next 100 starts the same way this one did: one post, one week, one review at a time.

Ready to stack skills? This guide is part of the **0 to 100 series** — the same no-fluff, action-step format applied to the other pillars of making money online: *0 to 100: Affiliate Marketing* (turn the recommendations you're already making into serious commission income), *0 to 100: Earning Money with AI* (the tools from Stage 10, taken all the way to full income streams), and *0 to 100: Web Development with AI* (build and sell websites without a CS degree). Each guide stands alone, but they compound — your content skills feed your affiliate income, AI multiplies both, and web skills let you own your platform entirely. **Grab the complete 0 to 100 series bundle and get every guide at a fraction of the individual price.** You've already proven you can execute — you have the first 100 posts to show for it. Pick your next 0, and let's take it to 100.